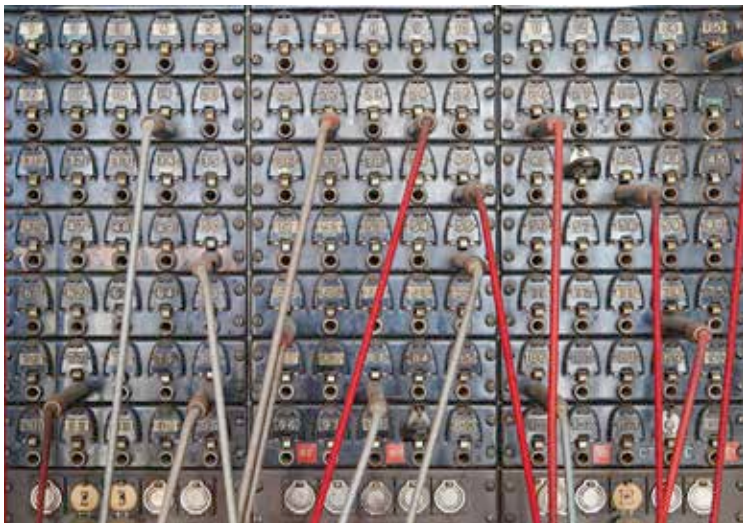




Maybe calls should be forwarded like this

Across the country, another switch received a message that a call from New York was on it's way, and began to update it's records to show the New York switch back on line. A second message from the New York switch then arrived, less than ten milliseconds after the first. Because the first message had not yet been handled, the second message should have been saved until later. A software defect then caused the second message to be written over crucial communications information. Software in the receiving switch detected the overwrite and immediately activated a backup link while it reset itself, but another pair of closely timed messages triggered the same response in the backup processor, causing it to shut down also. The problem repeated iteratively throughout the 114 switches in the network, blocking over 50 million calls in the nine hours it took to stabilise the system.

AT&T alone lost more than \$60 million in unconnected calls, of course the net loss due to the indirect business disruption from the terminated calls was significantly larger.

Passenger plane shot down by USS Vincennes(1988):

On July 3, 1988, 290 passengers and crew of Iran Air Flight 655 were travelling over an active conflict zone. However, sometime in the morning, the United States Navy guided missile cruiser Vincennes fired two missiles at